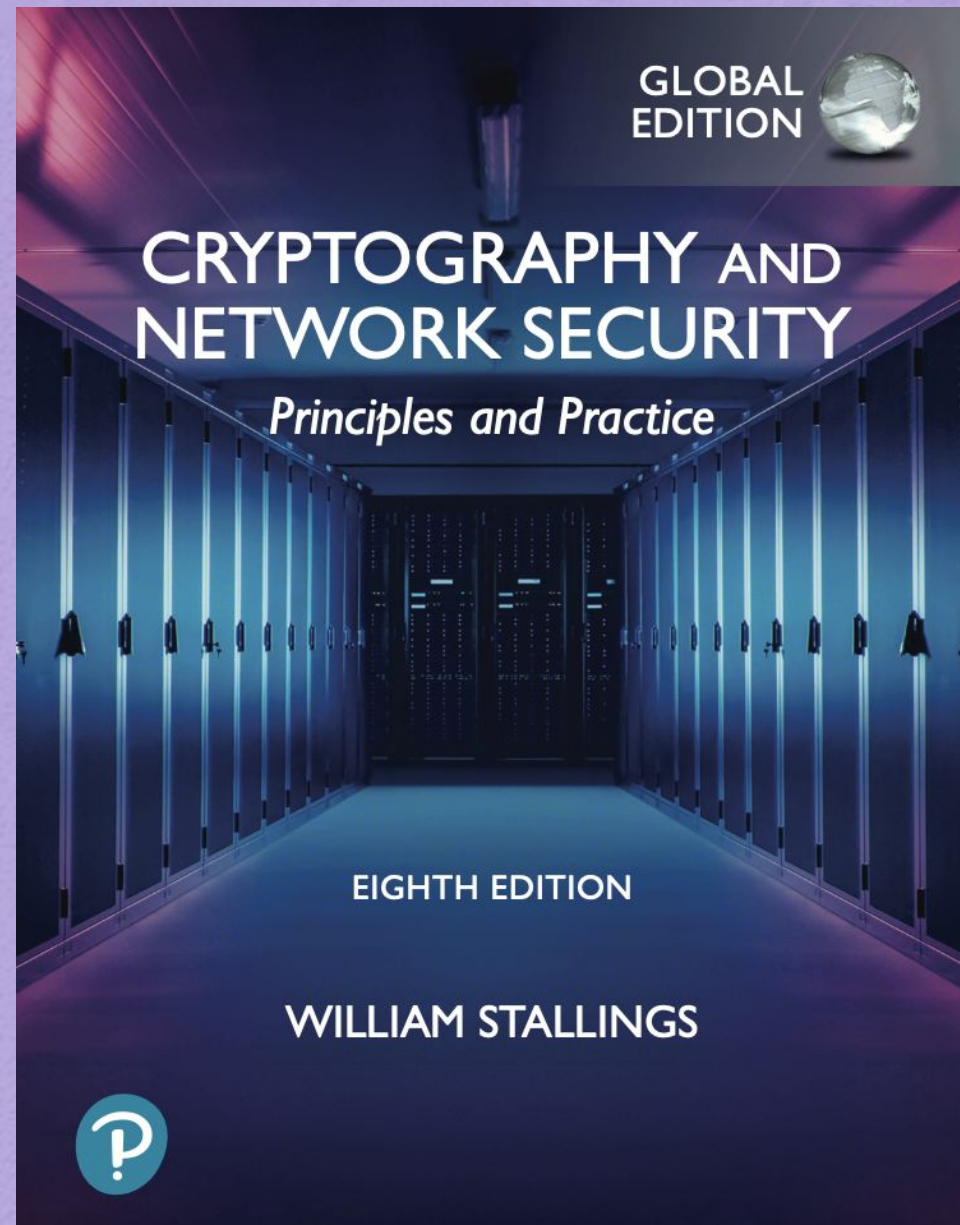


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CS454/654 Reliability and Security  
of Computing Systems - Fall 2024



# CHAPTER 10

## OTHER PUBLIC-KEY CRYPTOSYSTEMS

### 10.1 Diffie–Hellman Key Exchange

- The Algorithm
- Key Exchange Protocols
- Man-in-the-Middle Attack

### 10.2 ElGamal Cryptographic System

### 10.3 Elliptic Curve Arithmetic

- Abelian Groups
- Elliptic Curves over Real Numbers
- Elliptic Curves over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$
- Elliptic Curves over  $\text{GF}(2^m)$

### 10.4 Elliptic Curve Cryptography

- Analog of Diffie–Hellman Key Exchange
- Elliptic Curve Encryption/Decryption
- Security of Elliptic Curve Cryptography

### 10.5 Key Terms, Review Questions, and Problems



# Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange

- First published public-key algorithm
- A number of commercial products employ this key exchange technique
- Purpose is to enable two users to securely exchange a key that can then be used for subsequent symmetric encryption of messages
- The algorithm itself is limited to the exchange of secret values
- Its effectiveness depends on the difficulty of computing discrete logarithms

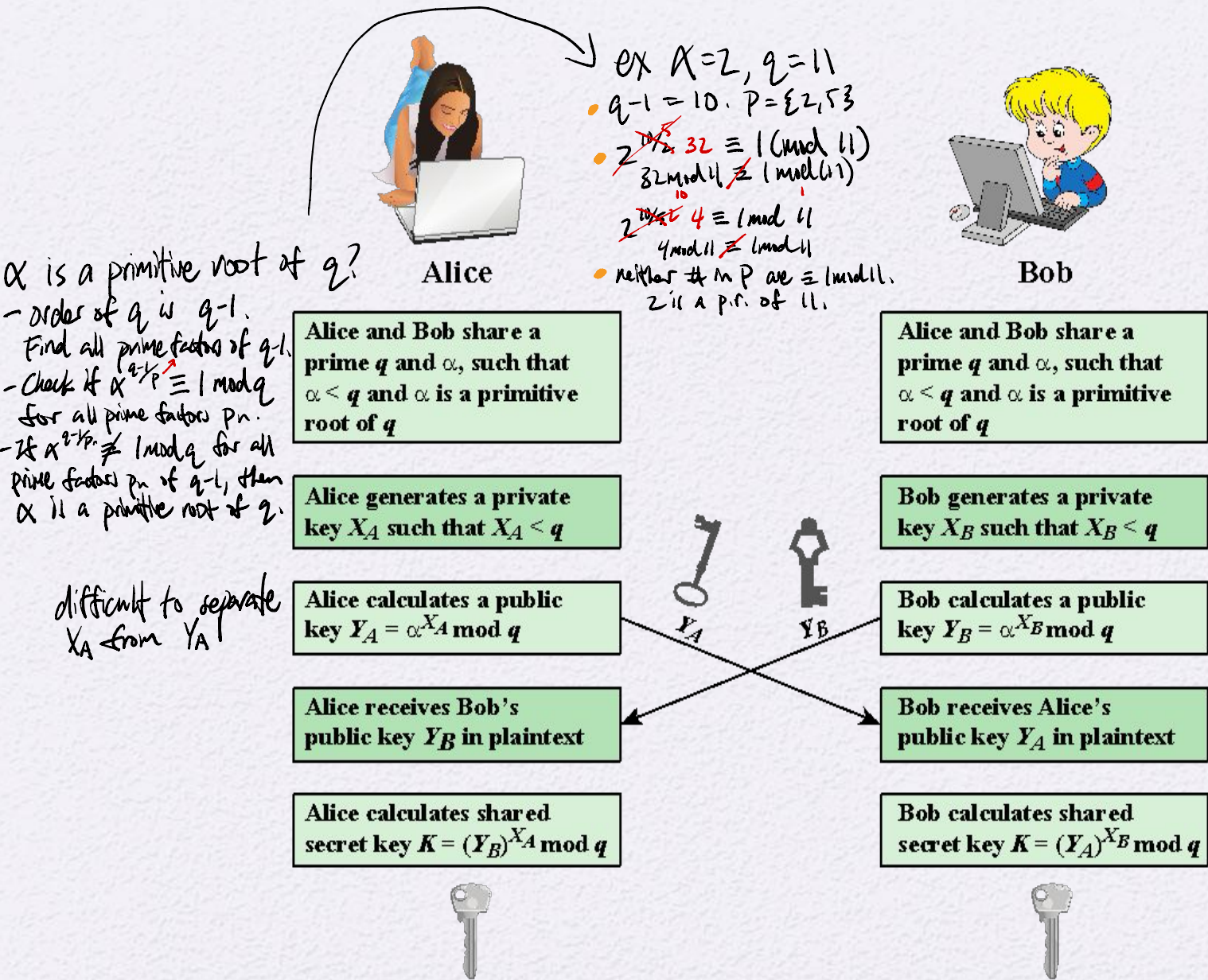


Figure 10.1 Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange



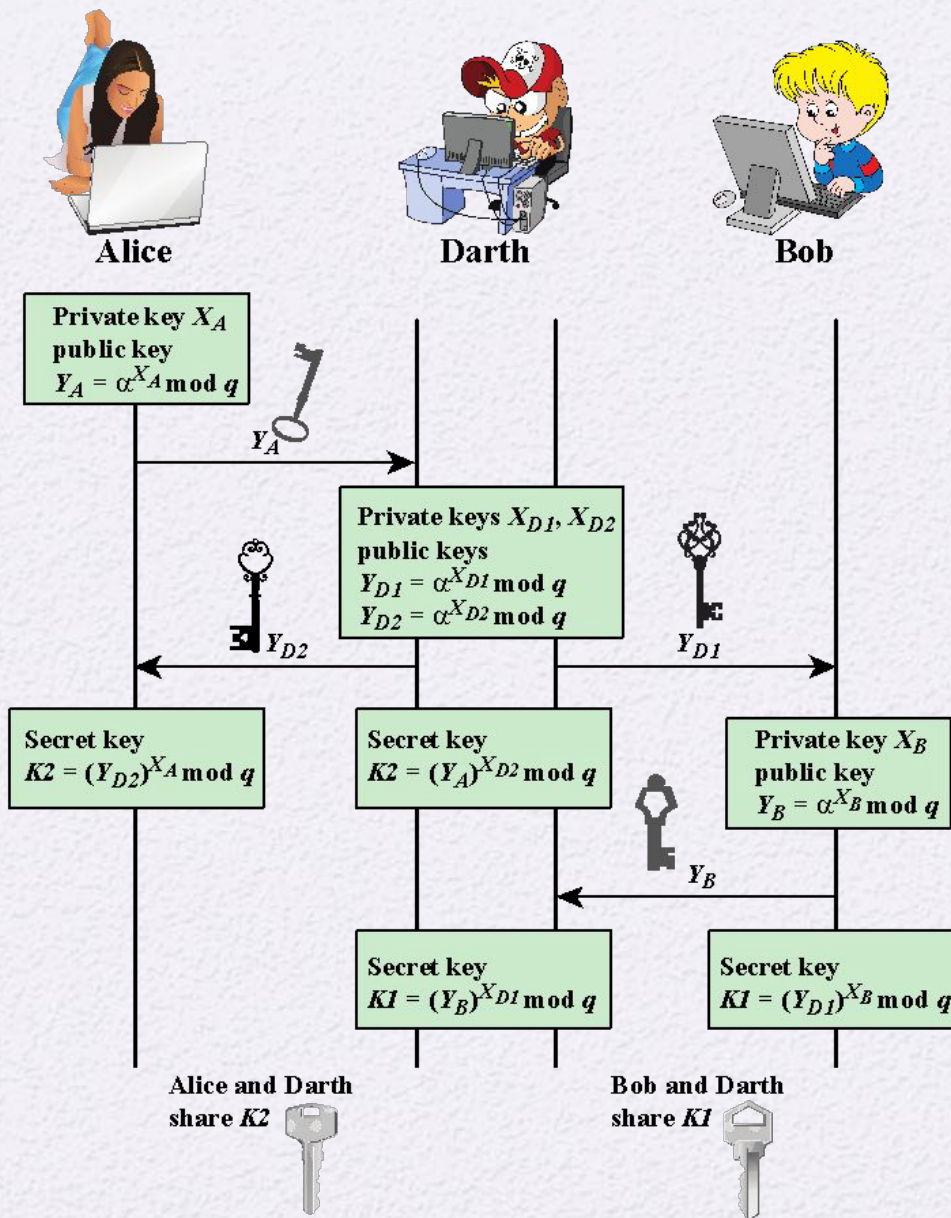


Figure 10.2 Man-in-the-Middle Attack

# ElGamal Cryptography

Announced in 1984  
by T. Elgamal

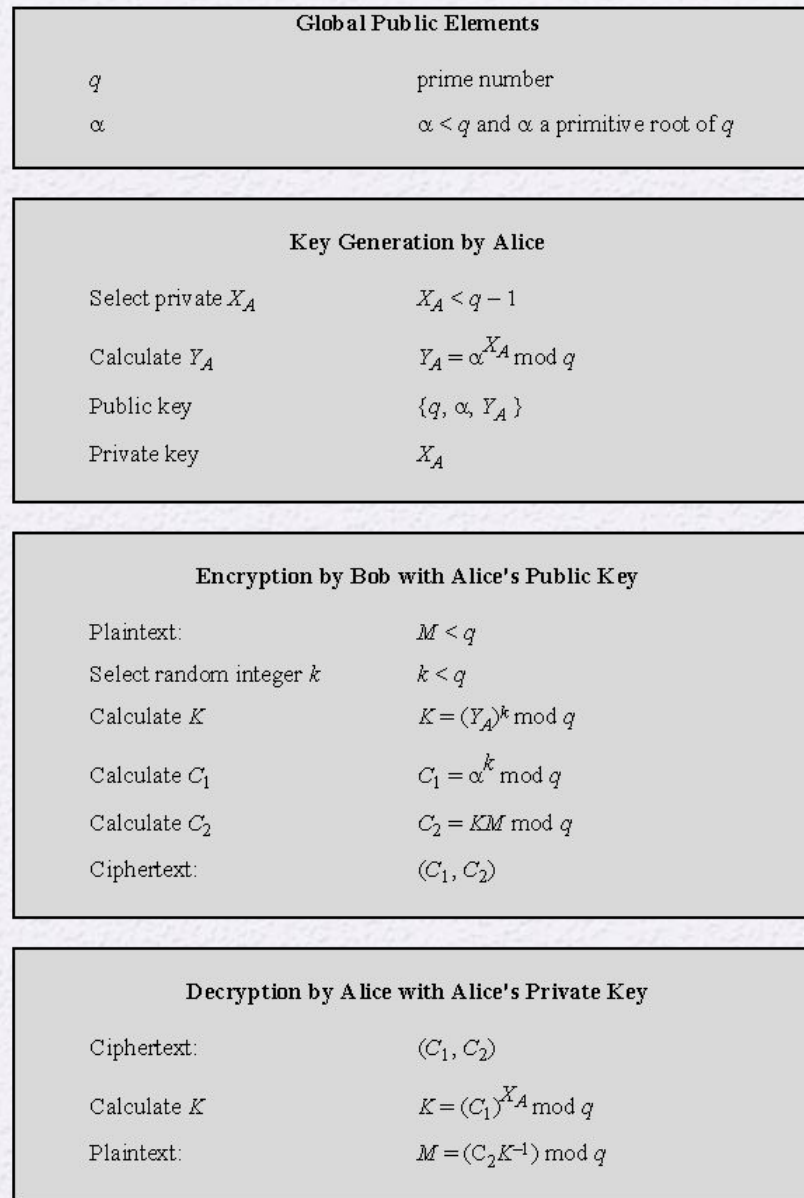
Public-key scheme  
based on discrete  
logarithms closely  
related to the  
Diffie-Hellman  
technique

Used in the digital  
signature standard  
(DSS) and the  
S/MIME e-mail  
standard

Global elements are  
a prime number  $q$   
and  $a$  which is a  
primitive root of  $q$

Security is based on  
the difficulty of  
computing discrete  
logarithms

*refer to slide #4*



**Figure 10.3 The ElGamal Cryptosystem**



# Elliptic Curve Arithmetic

- Most of the products and standards that use public-key cryptography for encryption and digital signatures use RSA
  - default nowadays is 2048-bit
- The key length for secure RSA use has increased over recent years and this has put a heavier processing load on applications using RSA
- Elliptic curve cryptography (ECC) is showing up in standardization efforts including the IEEE P1363 Standard for Public-Key Cryptography
  - standardization group
- Principal attraction of ECC is that it appears to offer equal security for a far smaller key size



# Abelian Group

- A set of elements with a binary operation, denoted by  $\cdot$ , that associates to each ordered pair  $(a, b)$  of elements in  $G$  an element  $(a \cdot b)$  in  $G$ , such that the following axioms are obeyed:

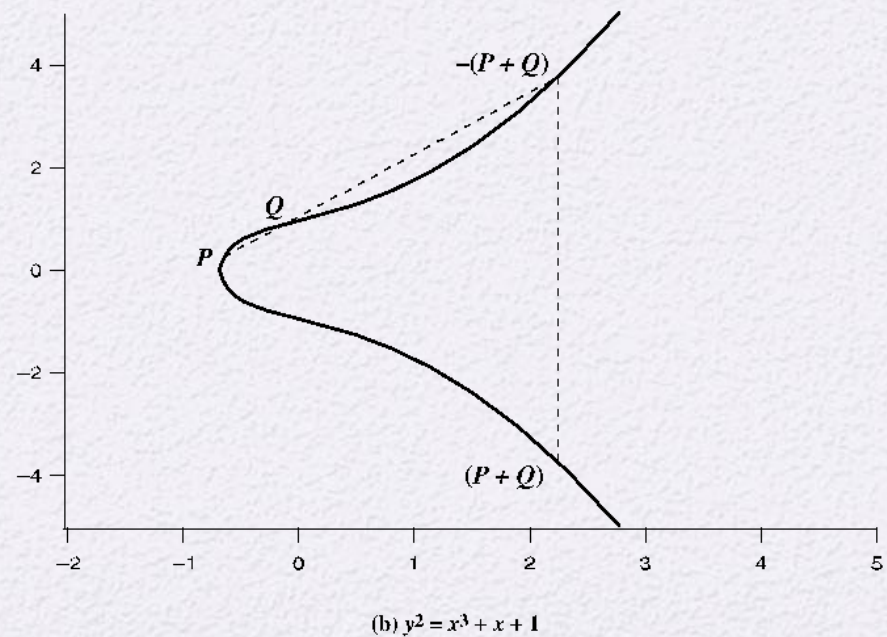
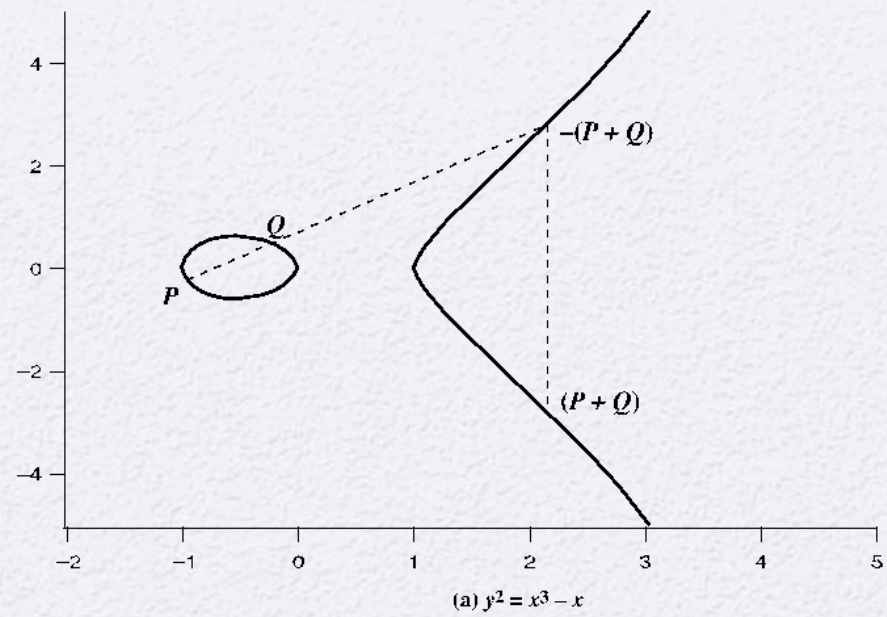
**(A1) Closure:** *→ like 456 automata!* If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $G$ , then  $a \cdot b$  is also in  $G$

**(A2) Associative:**  $a \cdot (b \cdot c) = (a \cdot b) \cdot c$  for all  $a, b, c$  in  $G$

**(A3) Identity element:** There is an element  $e$  in  $G$  such that  $a \cdot e = e \cdot a = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$

**(A4) Inverse element:** For each  $a$  in  $G$  there is an element  $a'$  in  $G$  such that  $a \cdot a' = a' \cdot a = e$

**(A5) Commutative:**  $a \cdot b = b \cdot a$  for all  $a, b$  in  $G$

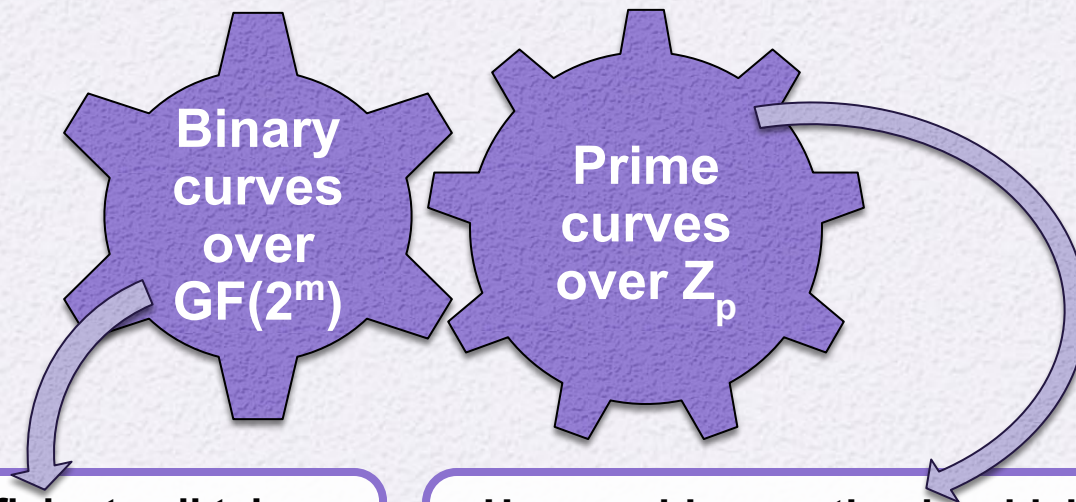


**Figure 10.4 Example of Elliptic Curves**



# Elliptic Curves Over $\mathbb{Z}_p$

- Elliptic curve cryptography uses curves whose variables and coefficients are finite
- Two families of elliptic curves are used in cryptographic applications:



- Variables and coefficients all take on values in  $\text{GF}(2^m)$  and in calculations are performed over  $\text{GF}(2^m)$
- Best for hardware applications

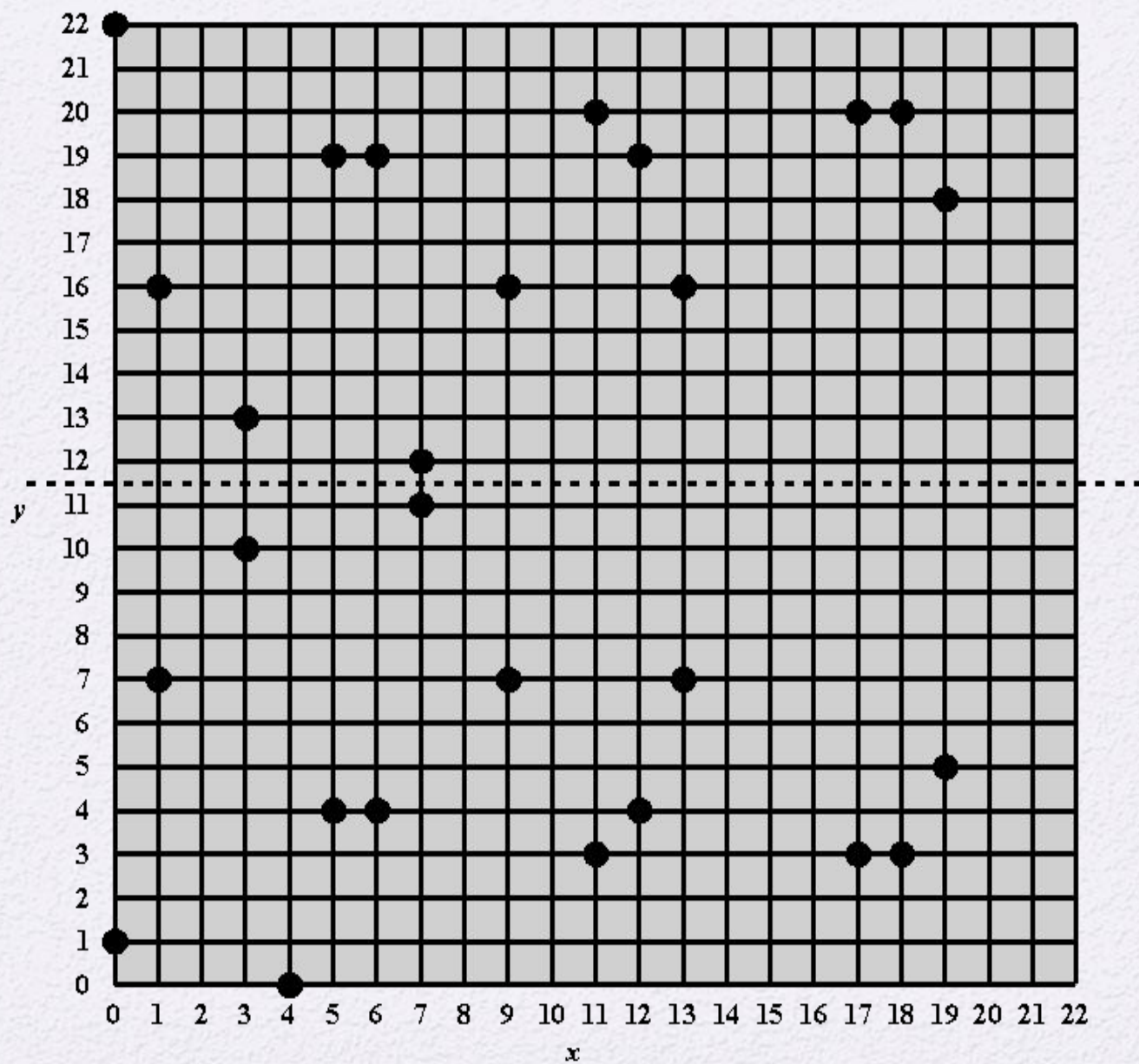
- Use a cubic equation in which the variables and coefficients all take on values in the set of integers from 0 through  $p-1$  and in which calculations are performed modulo  $p$
- Best for software applications

# Table 10.1

Points (other than  $O$ ) on the Elliptic Curve  $E_{23}(1, 1)$

|         |          |          |
|---------|----------|----------|
| (0, 1)  | (6, 4)   | (12, 19) |
| (0, 22) | (6, 19)  | (13, 7)  |
| (1, 7)  | (7, 11)  | (13, 16) |
| (1, 16) | (7, 12)  | (17, 3)  |
| (3, 10) | (9, 7)   | (17, 20) |
| (3, 13) | (9, 16)  | (18, 3)  |
| (4, 0)  | (11, 3)  | (18, 20) |
| (5, 4)  | (11, 20) | (19, 5)  |
| (5, 19) | (12, 4)  | (19, 18) |





**Figure 10.5 The Elliptic Curve  $E_{23}(1,1)$**

# Elliptic Curves Over $GF(2^m)$

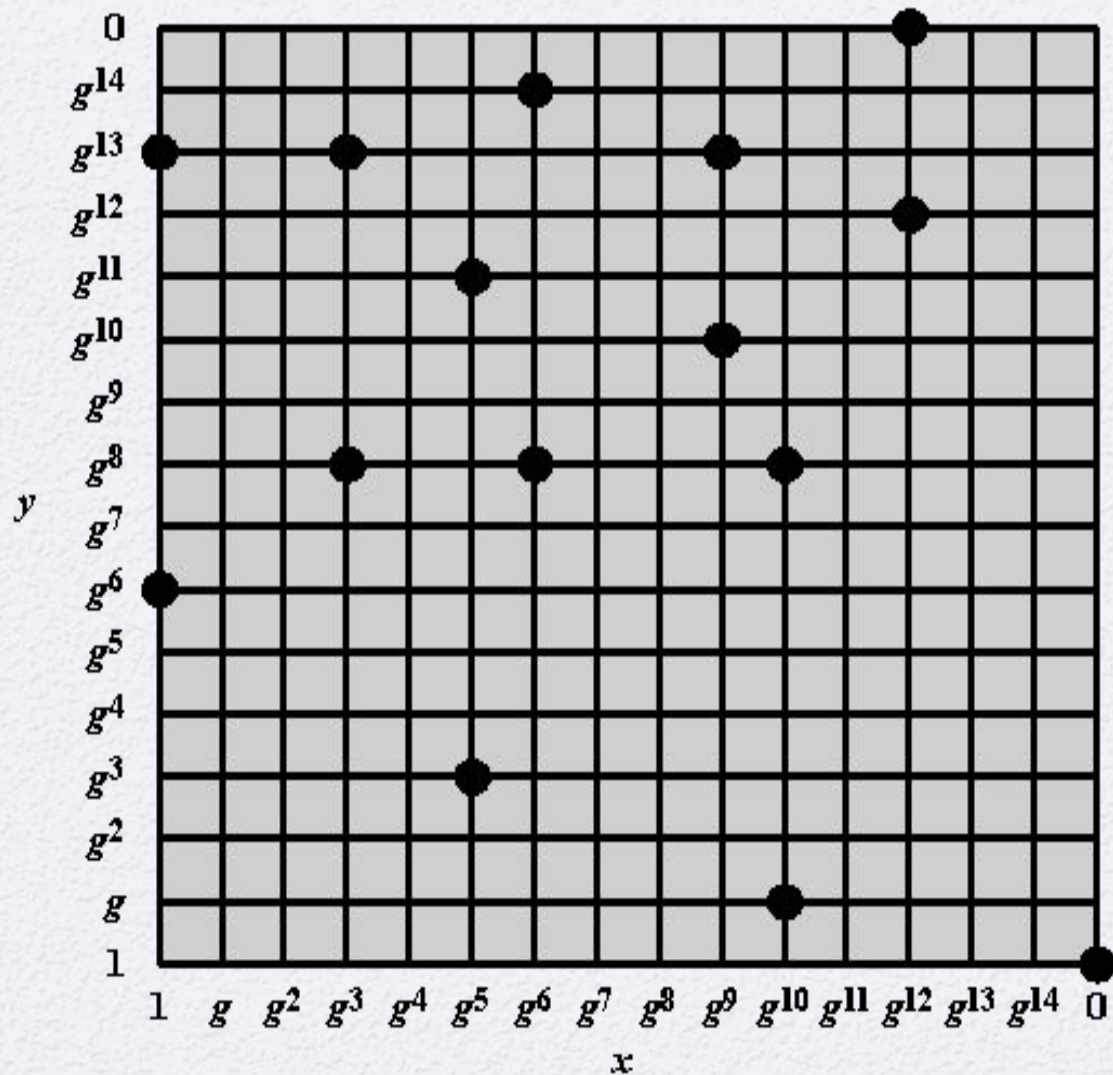
- Use a cubic equation in which the variables and coefficients all take on values in  $GF(2^m)$  for some number  $m$
- Calculations are performed using the rules of arithmetic in  $GF(2^m)$
- The form of cubic equation appropriate for cryptographic applications for elliptic curves is somewhat different for  $GF(2^m)$  than for  $Z_p$ 
  - It is understood that the variables  $x$  and  $y$  and the coefficients  $a$  and  $b$  are elements of  $GF(2^m)$  and that calculations are performed in  $GF(2^m)$



# Table 10.2

Points (other than  $O$ ) on the Elliptic Curve  $E_2^4(g^4, 1)$

|                 |                 |                    |
|-----------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| $(0, 1)$        | $(g^5, g^3)$    | $(g^9, g^{13})$    |
| $(1, g^6)$      | $(g^5, g^{11})$ | $(g^{10}, g)$      |
| $(1, g^{13})$   | $(g^6, g^8)$    | $(g^{10}, g^8)$    |
| $(g^3, g^8)$    | $(g^6, g^{14})$ | $(g^{12}, 0)$      |
| $(g^3, g^{13})$ | $(g^9, g^{10})$ | $(g^{12}, g^{12})$ |



**Figure 10.6** The Elliptic Curve  $E_{2^4}(g^4, 1)$

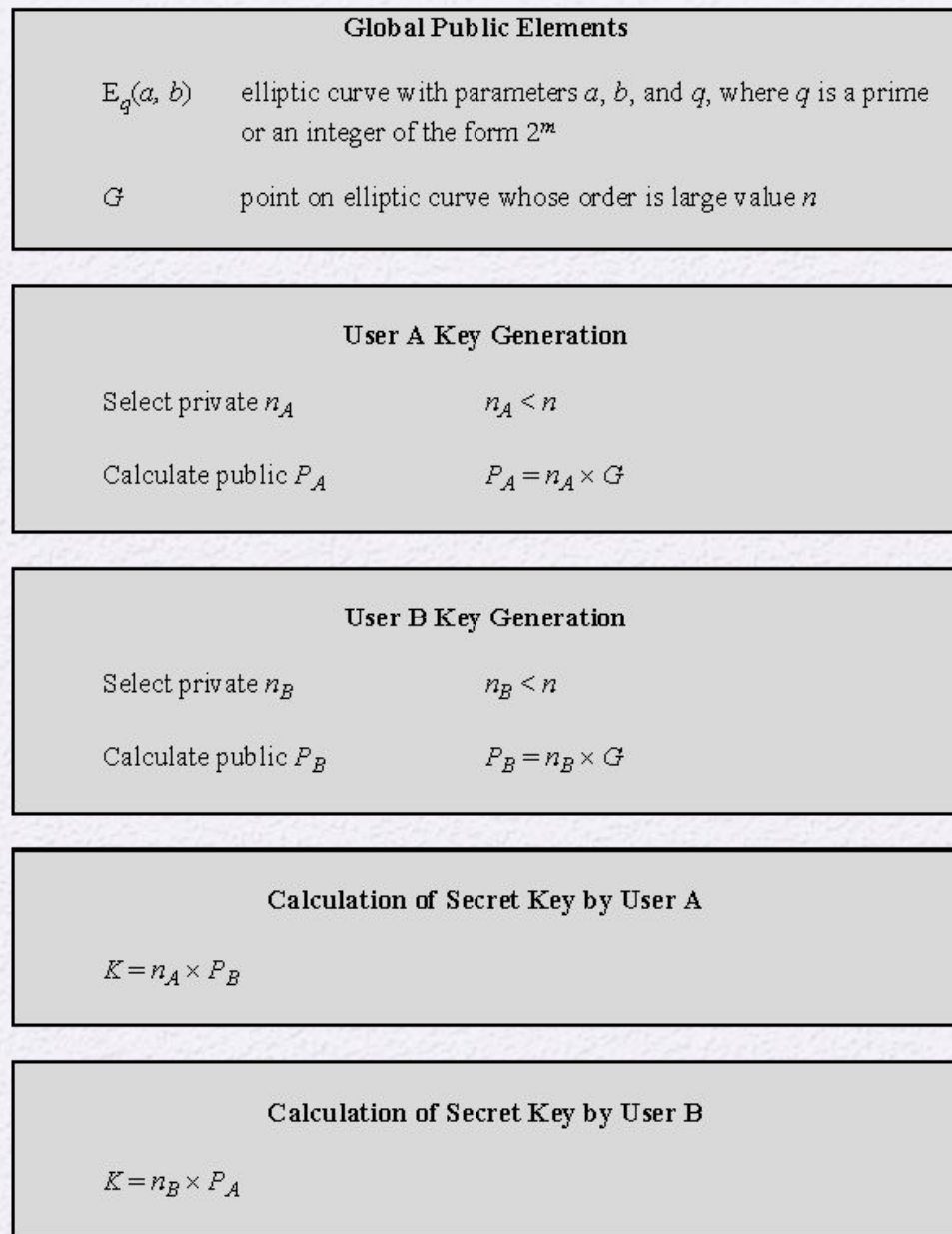


# Elliptic Curve Cryptography (ECC)

- Addition operation in ECC is the counterpart of modular multiplication in RSA
- Multiple addition is the counterpart of modular exponentiation

To form a cryptographic system using elliptic curves, we need to find a “hard problem” corresponding to factoring the product of two primes or taking the discrete logarithm

- $Q=kP$ , where  $Q, P$  belong to a prime curve
- Is “easy” to compute  $Q$  given  $k$  and  $P$
- But “hard” to find  $k$  given  $Q$ , and  $P$
- Known as the elliptic curve logarithm problem



**Figure 10.7 ECC Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange**



# Security of Elliptic Curve Cryptography

- Depends on the difficulty of the elliptic curve logarithm problem
- Fastest known technique is “Pollard  $\rho$  method”
- Compared to factoring, can use much smaller key sizes than with RSA
- For equivalent key lengths computations are roughly equivalent
- Hence, for similar security ECC offers significant computational advantages

# Table 10.3

## Comparable Key Sizes in Terms of Computational Effort for Cryptanalysis (NIST SP-800-57)

| Symmetric key algorithms | Diffie-Hellman, Digital Signature Algorithm | RSA (size of $n$ in bits) | ECC (modulus size in bits) |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| 80                       | $L = 1024$<br>$N = 160$                     | 1024                      | 160–223                    |
| 112                      | $L = 2048$<br>$N = 224$                     | 2048                      | 224–255                    |
| 128                      | $L = 3072$<br>$N = 256$                     | 3072                      | 256–383                    |
| 192                      | $L = 7680$<br>$N = 384$                     | 7680                      | 384–511                    |
| 256                      | $L = 15,360$<br>$N = 512$                   | 15,360                    | 512+                       |

Note:  $L$  = size of public key,  $N$  = size of private key



Public key cryptography fundamentally relies on the concept of a trapdoor function. It operates like a sophisticated trap: a rat (representing the data) gets caught using the public key, but it cannot escape on its own. However, with the knowledge of a specific method—the private key—the rat can be freed effortlessly. This elegantly demonstrates the power and precision of mathematics, ensuring that while anyone can set the trap (encrypt), only the intended recipient can unlock it (decrypt) 😊.

#PublicKeyCryptography

#Security

#RSA

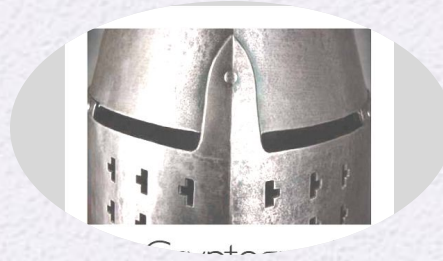
↑ using public key

using private key



# Summary

- Define Diffie-Hellman Key Exchange
- Understand the Man-in-the-middle attack
- Present an overview of the Elgamal cryptographic system



- Understand Elliptic curve arithmetic
- Present an overview of elliptic curve cryptography
- Present two techniques for generating pseudorandom numbers using an asymmetric cipher